

SWARTHMORE

I would describe an ideal Swarthmore essay as:

- Deeply intellectual and showing an enthusiasm for expanding mental boundaries
- Showing unconventional solutions to conventional problems
- Very quirky exhibiting a tendency to get off the main path and explore the bushes
- Going a bit overboard in the pursuit of your interests to the point of lunacy
- Dedication to the school before, during and after admissions ie contribution to the community willingness to be part of the active alumni
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Hacks

- Take a look at their admissions emails. The school loves going the extra mile in even the most mundane of topics.
- There's 3 topics for the supplement, that are very different so pick the simplest one for you. Neither is preferred over the other.
- The African card coupled with the sympathy card is a perfect play. Appeal to the minority requirement.
- Religion is a big part of the school culture so this is a potential avenue.
- LORs can make or break your application. Similarly showing a tendency to be close to your professors goes a long way.

Notes

Swarthmore essays are biased toward quirky yet vulnerable essays. Make use of the additional information spaces to include tiny tidbits that may work in your favor.